

Get your OpenAI API key

1

Sign in to the OpenAI Platform

Open the Platform and sign in, or create an account. Complete any setup prompts.

[Open Platform](#)

2

Add credit for API usage

Open Billing, add a payment method if needed, and choose the option to add credit. Review the amount before paying. If offered, leave auto recharge off for manual top-ups.

[Open Billing](#)

3

Create your API key

Open API Keys and select your project if prompted. Choose **Create new secret key** (or the create-key option), give it a name such as **My app**, and create it.

[Open API Keys](#)

4

Save and connect the key

Copy the key immediately and save it securely. Enter it in your app's private OpenAI API-key setting or secret storage. Treat it like a password and keep it out of shared files.

5

Check usage and spending

Make a small test request, then check Usage in the dashboard. In Limits, set a spend alert and an optional monthly spending cap.

[View model pricing](#)

Official OpenAI documentation

[API quickstart](#)

[Billing limits and key safety](#)